

Fynla v0.9.0 Patch Notes

Released: 15 March 2026 **Previous version:** v0.8.3

Headline

The Fynla Brain has been upgraded from static rule-based advice to a dynamic, data-aware decision engine. Every module now validates your data before running analysis, every tax value is centralised, and recommendations are transparent — you can see exactly why each one was made.

What's New

Fynla Brain Decision Engine

The core engine powering all financial analysis has been completely rebuilt.

Data Readiness Gates All five modules now check your data is complete before running analysis. If something is missing, you'll see exactly what's needed with a direct link to add it. No more misleading results from incomplete information.

Investment Pipeline A new 9-phase engine analyses your investments systematically:

1. Safety checks and emergency fund validation
2. Life event impact assessment
3. Goal mapping and progress tracking
4. Contribution waterfall — prioritises where your money should go (Lifetime ISA → ISA → Pension → Premium Bonds → General Investment Account)
5. Transfer scans — identifies 13 types of optimisation opportunities
6. Spouse optimisation — 7 strategies for couples (Capital Gains Tax sharing, ISA coordination, pension prioritisation)
7. Conflict resolution — removes duplicates and ranks by impact

107 Recommendation Triggers Recommendations are now driven by database triggers instead of hardcoded rules:

- 41 savings triggers (emergency fund, ISA, rate comparison, Personal Savings Allowance, Financial Services Compensation Scheme exposure)
- 28 protection triggers (employer benefits, policy trust status, expiry alerts, income protection)
- 18 retirement triggers (salary sacrifice, auto-enrolment, enhanced annuity, care costs)
- 14 investment triggers (fees, rebalancing, tax loss harvesting, bonds)
- 6 tax optimisation triggers

Centralised Tax Engine Every UK tax value — Nil Rate Band, ISA allowance, Pension Annual Allowance, Personal Savings Allowance, Capital Gains Tax exemption, and more — is now sourced from a single service. When HMRC changes rates, one update applies everywhere.

Savings Module

- **Personal Savings Allowance analysis** — see how much tax-free interest you have left and whether you're at risk of breaching it
- **Financial Services Compensation Scheme exposure** — warnings when your savings at one banking group exceed the £85,000 protection limit
- **Smart emergency fund targets** — 9 months if self-employed, 6 if employed, 3 if retired
- **Daily alerts** — maturity reminders at 90, 30, and 7 days; rate expiry notifications; year-end ISA allowance warnings

Estate Planning

- **2027 pension amendment** — see how your Inheritance Tax liability changes when pensions become part of your estate from April 2027, with side-by-side current vs amended projections
- **14-year gift rule** — historical chargeable lifetime transfers now correctly reduce the Nil Rate Band available for later gifts
- **Enhanced life insurance checks** — warnings for policies not held in trust, single-life policies for married users, and term policies approaching expiry
- **Trust projections** — year-by-year growth trajectory for planned trust settlements

Retirement

- **Salary sacrifice analysis** — see how much National Insurance you and your employer save, with warnings for sacrifices that push you below the Personal Allowance
- **Auto-enrolment compliance** — checks whether you're meeting the minimum 8% total contribution (3% employer, 5% employee)
- **Enhanced annuity assessment** — if you smoke or have health conditions, your annuity rate could be significantly higher

Protection

- **Employer benefits** — death-in-service, group income protection, and group critical illness cover are now deducted from your coverage gaps
- **State benefits offset** — Statutory Sick Pay correctly calculated at £118.75/week for up to 28 weeks (excluded for self-employed)
- **Descriptive ratings** — coverage status shown as Excellent, Good, Fair, or Critical instead of numeric scores

Plan Isolation

Individual module plans now contain only their own recommendations. Cross-module optimisation — pension contributions for the higher-rate partner, savings allowance sharing, marriage allowance — only appears in the Holistic Plan where everything is coordinated together.

Bug Fixes

Login Verification (Critical)

The verification code entered after login was failing with a 422 error. The root cause was challenge tokens stored in the application cache — when the cache driver resolved to in-memory only, tokens were lost between requests. Challenge tokens are now stored in the database, making login reliable regardless of cache configuration.

Security

- User ID removed from pre-authentication API responses to prevent user enumeration
- Sensitive fields (passwords, tokens, API keys) filtered from preview mode responses

Plan Endpoints

- Investment plan no longer crashes for personas with Lifetime ISA goals (was passing an array to a number formatter)
- Retirement plan no longer crashes for already-retired users without a retirement profile
- Plan action priorities correctly handle both string and integer values

Investment Plan Quality

- All 15 actions now have meaningful titles and descriptions instead of generic "Recommendation" placeholders
- Pension, savings allowance, and marriage allowance actions removed from the individual investment plan (moved to holistic plan only)

Property Page

- Property page no longer shows a blank content area after the API response format was standardised
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Code Quality

- **13 code review issues fixed** — hardcoded Inheritance Tax values replaced with tax configuration imports, hardcoded hex colours replaced with design system constants, score badges replaced with descriptive text, duplicate CSS extracted to global stylesheet, dead code removed, architecture tests added, query limits on all index endpoints
 - **1,873 automated tests passing** (up from 1,871)
 - **246 files changed** across the codebase
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Technical Notes

- 9 new database migrations (plus 11 pre-existing March migrations that hadn't been deployed)
 - Database seeding adds 107 recommendation triggers and disables 7 overlapping investment triggers
 - All frontend changes compiled into `public/build/` — no server-side build required
 - Cache must be cleared after deployment (`php artisan cache:clear`)
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Known Issues

- `savings:send-alerts` command references a `rate_valid_until` column that doesn't exist yet — rate expiry alerts will not fire until a future migration adds this column
 - Dashboard aggregator returns stub data for the financial health summary — real module data is used on individual module pages
 - Retired couple persona: retirement analysis returns zeros (already retired, no projection needed)
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v0.9.1 — Decision Tree Traceability (15 March 2026)

Actions Dashboard Rebuild

The Actions page has been completely rebuilt. Instead of a flat list of recommendations, actions are now grouped by module (Protection, Investment, Retirement, Estate) in a clean two-column grid, sourced directly from your financial plans.

Each action is clickable — tapping it opens a detail view showing exactly how the Fynla Brain arrived at that recommendation.

Decision Tree Visualisation

Every recommendation now includes a full decision trace — a step-by-step record of every piece of data gathered, every check performed, and how each drove the outcome. The detail view shows this in two formats side by side:

- **Decision Tree** — a visual flowchart with green (passed) and red (failed) nodes
- **Decision Trace** — a vertical timeline walking through each step with your actual data

For example, a "Consider Salary Sacrifice" recommendation shows:

1. Your profile (name, age, employment status, income)
2. Your pension details (provider, fund value, contribution rates, employer match)
3. Whether it's a workplace pension eligible for salary sacrifice
4. The National Insurance savings calculation (employee and employer)
5. The recommended action with monthly savings figure
6. How April 2029 legislation changes will affect the saving

April 2029 Salary Sacrifice Changes

From April 2029, only the first £2,000 of employee salary sacrifice pension contributions will be exempt from National Insurance. Contributions above £2,000 will be subject to National Insurance for both employee and employer.

The salary sacrifice analysis now shows both current and post-2029 scenarios:

- Current National Insurance saving
- Post-2029 National Insurance saving (capped at £2,000 exemption)
- The reduction in saving
- Confirmation that employer contributions and Income Tax relief are unaffected

This is sourced from the UK Government announcement: [Changes to salary sacrifice for pensions from April 2029](#).

Other Changes

- "Early Retirement Fund" goal renamed to "Pre-Pension Bridge Fund" — clarifies this is an investment bridge to cover living costs before pensions become accessible, not a pension contribution goal

Questions or issues? Report via the in-app Bug Report button or contact the development team.